

AFRICA INNOVATORS SOCIETY

at Carnegie Mellon University Africa

WEBSITE PLAN

1. Website Goals & Objectives

The AIS website will serve as the primary digital home for the club. It should accomplish the following:

- Establish a credible and inspiring online presence for AIS
- Attract new student members and build a pipeline of engaged entrepreneurs
- Showcase AIS programs, events, competitions, and member successes
- Facilitate communication between current members, alumni, and external stakeholders
- Provide a hub for resources, announcements, and opportunities
- Enable external stakeholders (mentors, sponsors, partners) to connect with AIS

1.1 Target Audiences

Audience	Primary Need	Key Goal
Prospective Members	Understand what AIS offers	Inspire them to join
Current Members	Access resources & events	Keep them engaged
Mentors & Speakers	Learn about AIS & apply	Enable easy onboarding
Sponsors & Partners	Understand AIS impact	Facilitate partnerships
Media & Public	Discover AIS story	Build credibility & visibility

2. Site Map & Page Structure

The AIS website will be structured around six primary pages, with a top navigation bar. Below is a proposed site map:

africainnovators.cmu.edu (Example Root Domain)					
Home	About	Programs	Events	Community	Contact

3.1 Page Descriptions

 Home	
Description The landing page. Creates a strong first impression, communicates AIS's mission at a glance, and directs users to key sections.	Key Features • Hero banner with tagline and call-to-action (Join AIS / Explore Programs) • Mission & vision snapshot • Impact statistics (100+ members, events per year, etc.) • Featured upcoming event • Testimonial/quote from a member or alumni • Partner and sponsor logos
 About	
Description Tells the full story of AIS — who they are, where they came from, and what drives them.	Key Features • Origin story and history of AIS • Mission, vision, and values • Leadership team profiles (photos, roles, LinkedIn links) • Affiliations with CMU-Africa and partner organisations
 Programs	
Description Highlights AIS's core offerings, giving potential and current members a clear picture of how they can get involved and grow.	Key Features • Skills workshops overview • Pitch competition details (AIS Pitch Night, Startup Weekend, etc.) • Mentorship programme description

- Networking events
- Application / Interest form link

 Events

Description

A dynamic, filterable events hub that keeps members and the public informed about upcoming and past AIS activities.

Key Features

- Upcoming events calendar / list view
- Past events archive with photos/recaps
- RSVP / Registration links
- Guest speaker spotlights

 Community

Description

Celebrates AIS members and their ventures, building credibility and inspiring others.

Key Features

- Member spotlight / success stories
- Alumni venture showcase
- Startup portfolio (ventures started by AIS members)
- Mentor directory

 Contact

Description

A simple, professional contact hub for all stakeholder types — members, sponsors, mentors, and media.

Key Features

- General contact form
- Separate forms for: Mentorship applications, Sponsorship enquiries
- Social media links
- AIS email and CMU-Africa address
- Newsletter signup

3. Design Direction

3.1 Brand & Visual Identity

Primary Color	Deep Red / Crimson
Secondary Color	Dark Charcoal
Accent	Warm Gold or Amber
Typography	Clean sans-serif fonts (e.g. Inter, Poppins, or similar) for readability

Imagery	Photos of AIS events
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3.2 Key Design Principles

- Mobile-first: Majority of users will visit via smartphones
- Fast-loading: Optimised images and lightweight code for lower-bandwidth contexts
- Accessible: WCAG 2.1 AA compliance — readable contrast, alt text, keyboard navigation
- Consistent: Unified component library across all pages
- African identity: Photography and language that authentically represents CMU-Africa students

4. Features & Functionality

4.1 Core Features (Must-Have)

Feature	Purpose	Priority
Responsive Design	Works on all screen sizes	Critical
Events Calendar	Keep community informed	High
Contact Forms	Enable stakeholder engagement	High
Member/Alumni Spotlight	Build credibility	High
Social Media Links	Community connectivity	High
Newsletter Signup	Grow communication list	Medium
Photo Gallery	Showcase real events	Medium
SEO Optimisation	Discoverability on Google	Medium

5 More Features

- Blog / Insights page authored by AIS members
- Grants and Funding opportunity board for startups
- Startup pitch video embed showcase
- Multilingual support (English / French for broader Africa reach)
- Event Registration through google forms because we wont have a backend
- Leadership Page(From the Founder to the current club leadership, with pictures and bio)

5. Technologies

The following technology options are proposed based on ease of use, maintainability, and suitability for a student-run club:

Option A (Recommended)	Next.js (React) + Tailwind CSS + Contentlayer for content. Hosted on Vercel. Best for a team with some web dev experience.
Domain	Vercel or Github co-domain
Hosting	Vercel (free tier) or Github.io